



Market Briefs **Pro**

Read less news

Good morning, Pro Briefers!

11 months ago. Wall Street analysts and some investors were worried about the future of markets.

Why? The S&P 500 had just wrapped up its second straight year of 20%+ gains.

The question on everyone's mind: How could markets keep climbing?

Now, at the end of 2025, the S&P 500 actually closed out the year up around 15%.

S&P 500 (^GSPC)

YTD Price → **6780.36**
(15.31%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

That's higher than its historical average return of around 12% per year.

But it wasn't smooth sailing.

On April 2nd, President Trump announced "Liberation Day" - massive tariffs that sent the markets into a panic.

Markets fell 10-12% in the following weeks.

Then, months later, a new fear roiled markets: A potential AI bubble.

Massive investments into AI, data centers, and tech have some investors worried that it may be difficult to get the same level of returns.

Between November 12 and November 18, 2025, the Dow and Nasdaq both fell over 4% as a result.

Still, the market kept hitting record highs, but investors are now starting to worry once again, asking:

What about jobs? What about inflation? Does the stock market even reflect what's happening in the real economy anymore?

That caused gold and silver to set new records, too - as the U.S. put precious metals and other rare earth minerals in the spotlight.

It's safe to say 2025 has been a whirlwind year for markets. But through it all, we spotted opportunities.

Our analysts spent 2025 hunting for opportunities using our 5 Market Shifts framework - we met with experts and travelled the world, and reported on events in real time.

In the end, we identified hundreds of potential investment opportunities.

Certain macroeconomic events also impacted some of the shifts we spotted more than anticipated, and we identified catalyst events that didn't end up happening.

Today, we're looking back at 2025. We're going to show you where we were right, what didn't happen, and where we think the opportunities are heading in 2026.

We'll break it down in three ways:

- Tech, AI & Data
- Resources, Energy & Materials
- Geopolitics

Let's take a look.

The Tech Revolution

AI became one of the most sought-after tools on earth.

And Wall Street showed it is all-in on the investment.

Sources anticipate that roughly \$1.5 trillion will be invested into AI this year.

This spending was led by hyperscalers like Amazon, Microsoft, and Google - as they partner with leading AI names like Nvidia and OpenAI to create data centers and advanced tech.

Our strategy: Focus on the picks-and-shovels companies - the businesses that provide the raw materials AI needs to run.

Why? These companies create the infrastructure for all things tech - whether there's a bubble or not, these companies should still benefit in the long run.

This idea even applied to the automotive industry - namely, electric vehicle infrastructure companies.

What Did Well

EV Infrastructure

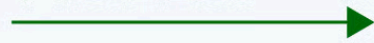
Back in March, we broke down new opportunities in electric vehicle infrastructure.

Not the car companies themselves - the suppliers that make EVs possible.

Amphenol, one of the companies we highlighted, has grown since then. Shares jumped over 90% in 2025, which outpaced the S&P 500.

Amphenol Corporation (APH)

YTD Price



135.07
(94.41%)



Market Briefs Pro

Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

Banking Tech

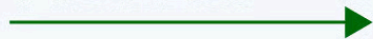
We also dove deep into banking technology - specifically the new wave of digital-only banks and the software that powers them.

Companies like SoFi and Nu Holdings had incredible years. SoFi alone is up more than 75% year-to-date. Nu is ending the year up around 60%.

These companies are revolutionizing finance - and in 2025, they outperformed their legacy banking counterparts like JPMorgan and Bank of America.

SoFi Technologies, Inc. (SOFI)

YTD Price



27.33
(77.27%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

What's on the Horizon

New AI Systems

We highlighted C3.AI as a company that could help businesses quickly adopt AI systems.

It turns out, most companies don't need these complicated systems yet.

Instead, many turned to free or simple systems like ChatGPT or Claude.

C3.AI is down more than 50% year-to-date.

That said, we still think C3.AI has potential for growth.

We are bullish on C3.AI going into 2026, but right now, it's a highly speculative bet.



Data via Yahoo! Finance

AGI

Our report on Artificial General Intelligence (AGI) told a similar story to our broader AI thesis.

The big players - Google, Nvidia, Broadcom - had banner years.

These companies outperformed the S&P 500, and we stand by our broader thesis:

AGI is AI that can think, learn, and understand in a way similar to humans - that tech isn't going away, but it could be decades before any real growth is shown.



Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

Shifts We're No Longer Tracking

3D Medical Printing

We also looked at 3D medical printing as an emerging opportunity.

We stand by our research - we feel the applications for this technology create a compelling investment opportunity.

But the technology isn't ready just yet.

And overall, this shift is earlier in its development cycle than we thought, so it's not an active shift we're tracking right now.



Fiserv

Fiserv was a growing opportunity in the banking space.

This company builds digital infrastructure for financial services.

They had a booming presence in South America - a region leading the digital banking revolution.

But the bank faced macroeconomic challenges - which we anticipated, but it was unable to recover like we thought it would.

Fiserv relied way too heavily on Argentina - when Argentina's economy crashed, Fiserv fell too.

The company missed earnings by 23%, which caused shares to drop more than 40% in a single day.

As a result Fiserv is down 66% year-to-date in 2025.

Fiserv is no longer an opportunity we're watching.

Fiserv, Inc. (FISV)

YTD Price

68.71
(-66.58%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

RESOURCES, ENERGY & MATERIALS

The Rise Of Infrastructure

Raw materials was one of the biggest drivers of our investment strategy in 2025.

The biggest reason? AI, EVs, and other industries need infrastructure, and that infrastructure needs certain materials to be built.

These include precious metals like gold and silver but also other minerals like lithium, and neodymium, the latter being a rare earth mineral.

What Did Well

Critical Minerals

The U.S. is trying to bring its supply chains back home so it relies less on countries like China for the things it needs.

This was one of the biggest reasons the U.S. raised tariffs earlier in 2025 - if it costs more to do business outside the U.S., there could be a cost incentive to bring that work here.

At the same time, demand for critical minerals keeps growing.

Energy Fuels Inc. - a company we featured in multiple reports - is up over 200% year-to-date as of December 23rd, 2025.

The company is a critical mineral miner for things like uranium and vanadium.

Energy Fuels Inc. (UUUU)

YTD Price

15.39
(201.27%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

Gold Miners

Precious metals like gold and silver continue to rise in demand and in price.

Gold mining companies specifically are not only benefiting, but outpacing the commodity itself in terms of growth.

The reason? Their profit margins kept growing as gold prices rose.

One opportunity we featured, Barrick Mining Corp, grew 190% in 2025.

Gold and silver can't rise forever. But after talking to industry experts, we believe precious metal mining will stay strong in 2026.



Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

Energy

We also researched opportunities in the energy industry this year.

Most of our research was related to two things:

- Uranium mining
- Data center energy

Both go hand in hand - a large portion of the world wants to increase its nuclear energy usage, because of its reliability and low carbon footprint.

At the same time, data center demand is growing - and new data centers are being built globally.

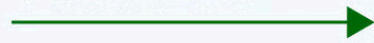
They use a tremendous amount of energy, and nuclear power could one day be a solution.

To be clear: Nuclear is not a solution yet for data centers - leading our analysts to find other growing opportunities to power the future of AI data centers in the short term.

We researched GE Vernova - which provides gas turbines to data centers - it rose 100% in 2025.

GE Vernova Inc. (GEV)

YTD Price



662.86
(101.40%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

What's on the Horizon

Critical Minerals

MP Materials actually went down since we featured them, hitting price corrections - this was more than anticipated, after the stock hit a record high in such a short period of time.

Investors took profits after massive runs.

Here's our take going into 2026: This is still an opportunity.

Critical mineral miners might drop more in early 2026, but they're inching toward profitability.

And this administration has made it clear that critical minerals and rare earths are a focus going forward.

Shifts We're No Longer Tracking

Kosmos Energy

But traditional oil and gas companies struggled as crude prices dropped to unsustainable lows.

Kosmos Energy went a different direction after our report.

Kosmos operates massive oil platforms off the coast of Africa.

From geopolitical tensions to rapidly falling oil prices, it's been a tough year for Kosmos, and there doesn't seem to be anything to change its trajectory.

Kosmos is down more than 71% year-to-date and faces potential delisting.

We initially thought Kosmos could rally with increased energy focus in Africa but conditions have gotten worse.

With that said, Kosmos is no longer an opportunity we're tracking.

Kosmos Energy Ltd. (KOS)

YTD Price

0.9817
(-71.30%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

GEOPOLITICS

The World Economy

If 2025 taught us anything, it's that predicting geopolitics is nearly impossible.

The April market crash. The ongoing Russia-Ukraine war. China withholding rare earths. Trade deal failures.

But through all the noise, we spotted an opportunity: emerging markets.

What Did Well

Emerging Markets

Reminder: Emerging markets (EMs) are economies transitioning from developing status into global powerhouses.

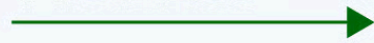
Many emerging market funds saw rapid growth in 2025 as these economies have grown and investors look to diversify away from American markets.

VWO - which tracks emerging markets - rose 21% year-to-date in 2025.

Some of these emerging markets aren't alone in their growth, though - they're teaming up to create a new trade alliance to spark growth even more.

Vanguard Emerging Markets Stock Index Fund (VWO)

YTD Price



53.46
(21.39%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

BRICS Nations

Our report researching the BRICS nations - Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa - which originally formed in 2009, started to gain major ground overseas.

Tariffs and supply chain independence in the U.S. are pushing BRICS countries to start trading more with each other and with other nations.

Funds like The iShares MSCI Brazil ETF, which we featured, increased up more 37% year-to-date.

iShares MSCI Brazil ETF (EWZ)

YTD Price

31.00
(37.09%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo Finance

Europe

The global economy had opportunities beyond BRICS too.

We highlighted opportunities in major European markets at the end of 2024, including Deutsche Bank and the iShares Poland ETF (EPOL).

Deutsche Bank is up more than 120% year-to-date as of December 2025.

Deutsche Bank Aktiengesellschaft (DB)

YTD Price

38.74
(126.31%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

Sovereign Wealth Funds

We researched sovereign wealth funds, using Saudi Arabia's Public Investment Fund (PIF) as a case study.

The PIF continued to be an incredible investment vehicle, boosting companies around the globe like Electronic Arts (EA).

What's on the Horizon

India

Our report on trade deals highlighted a potential opportunity with India.

Both the Indian government and the U.S. Treasury talked about a trade deal being done by the July deadline.

It never happened.

Not only was there no trade deal, but India got hit with much higher tariffs because they kept buying Russian oil.

We also expected pharmaceutical exemptions from India. This hasn't happened yet.

Instead, the U.S. government cracked down on imported generic drugs.

Dr. Reddy's - one of the companies we highlighted - got hit from both sides.

Dr. Reddy's is down more than 9% year-to-date.

Regardless, India is one of the fastest-growing economies in the world.

Our analysts firmly believe India is an investment opportunity today and in the future, but at this time, we are no longer watching these tickers:

- RDY
- INFY
- INDA

Dr. Reddy's Laboratories Limited (RDY)

YTD Price

14.21
(-9.55%)



 Market Briefs Pro

Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

Shifts We're No Longer Tracking

Lucid

But we saw the limits of the PIF's power with Lucid, the American EV maker.

Despite constant PIF support, multiple rallies, and even a reverse stock split, Lucid's share price kept falling throughout 2025.

Lucid might reach profitability someday. But right now, it's too volatile, with shares down more than 59% year-to-date as of December 2025.

It lost nearly half its value even after a 12-1 reverse stock split.

We no longer consider Lucid an opportunity.



Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

Looking Ahead To 2026

These companies represent just a fraction of the opportunities we identified in 2025.

And under our new strategy, our reports have beaten the S&P 500 by 5.8% from 11/2024 - 11/2025.

Some recent reports - like Japanese corporate reform and biotech - are just getting started.

Our analysts are keeping an eye on them to see how they play out.

Here's what we're bullish on heading into 2026:

- Supply chain bottlenecks
- Fast-growing global markets
- Raw materials that power the tech revolution

We'll keep using our 5 Market Shifts framework to find opportunities, but next year, we're going to go even deeper into our strategies and new shifts being born.

Our mission stays the same: Help you be better with money.

Thanks for being part of the Briefs Pro community in 2025. We can't wait to see what 2026 brings.



- Market Briefs Pro Team

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You are never guaranteed to make money when you invest, you might even lose money. If you're looking for personalized financial advice, we highly recommend speaking with a licensed financial advisor.

Our mission? It's simple - to help you be better with money.

Included interviews have been edited for length and clarity.

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